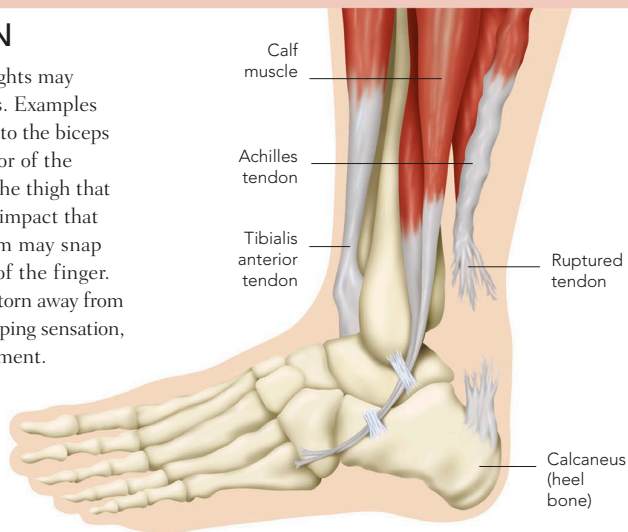


RUPTURED TENDON

Playing sport and lifting heavy weights may result in torn, or ruptured, tendons. Examples are tearing of the tendons attached to the biceps brachii muscle in the upper arm, or of the quadriceps tendon at the front of the thigh that stretches over the knee. A sudden impact that bends a fingertip towards the palm may snap the extensor tendon on the back of the finger. In severe cases, the tendon may be torn away from the bone. Symptoms include a snapping sensation, pain, swelling, and impaired movement.

TORN ACHILLES TENDON

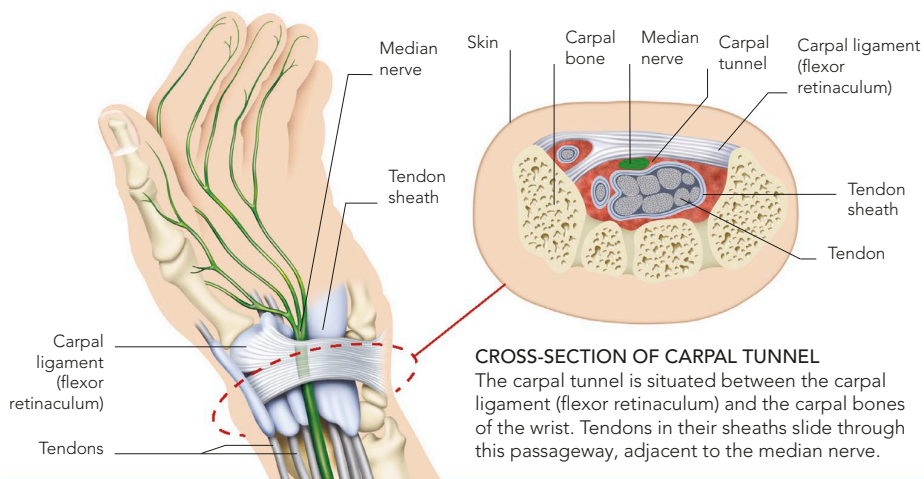
The Achilles tendon attaches the calf muscle to the heel bone. It can snap after sudden exertion and may need to be treated by surgery and immobilization in a cast.



CARPAL TUNNEL SYNDROME

The carpal tunnel is a narrow passage formed by the carpal ligament (flexor retinaculum), on the inside of the wrist, and the underlying wrist bones (carpals). Tendons run through the tunnel from the forearm muscles to the hand. The median nerve also passes through the carpal tunnel, to

control hand muscles and convey sensations from the fingers. In carpal tunnel syndrome (CTS), the median nerve is compressed by swelling of the tissues around it in the tunnel. Causes include diabetes mellitus, pregnancy, a wrist injury, rheumatoid arthritis, and repetitive movements.



CROSS-SECTION OF CARPAL TUNNEL

The carpal tunnel is situated between the carpal ligament (flexor retinaculum) and the carpal bones of the wrist. Tendons in their sheaths slide through this passageway, adjacent to the median nerve.